

Those items created a worldview for me that rejected the normal narrative of working until my mid-sixties, so I set out to find another path. Saving money to reduce my future need to work was what I landed on.

Jonathan

Although I realized FI was a goal as a young adult, my path wasn't optimized for FI. I wonder if I had been exposed to this information at a younger age how that could have affected my career selection and overall outlook on life. If you can lock down enough of these principles earlier in life, you're going to end up in a wonderful financial place.

Elizabeth (Liz) Willard Thames who writes the blog *Frugalwoods*, states that as young newlyweds, she and her husband would leave their jobs in Boston every weekend and drive several hours to get into the mountains and hike. Liz told Brad and Jonathan, "our best experiences were in the mountains, just spending time together walking around in nature, not buying anything, not consuming any media." But then they had to make the long drive home on Sunday to return to work on Monday.

The simple act of realizing what made them happy began to shape their future actions and decisions. They began thinking about